Afghanistan had direct bearing on the security situation in the tribal areas of Pakistan (Brynjar & Katja, 2000). There was a palpable apprehension that the TTP could gain strength after the withdrawal of international and US forces from Afghanistan in 2014. As Al Qaeda had been neutralised to a large extent, mainly through the US drone campaign, the US interest in supporting Pakistan to tackle TTP and its affiliates started petering out. It adversely affected Pakistan's capacity to fight against the insurgents and terrorists for a long time. In a nutshell, TTP and its affiliates, operating in an environment of widespread militancy, religious extremism and sectarianism throughout the country, especially in FATA, and their leadership and a large number of militants hiding safely in Afghanistan, would remain a grave threat to the stability of Pakistan.

Pakistan will have to go all out in a sustained and strong manner to remove extremism and terrorism without any latitude to any such group for any purpose. More importantly, to strangulate popular support to them, the religious elements dabbling in politics should be encouraged to join the mainstream national political parties instead of forming religio-political parties. The process of fencing the Pak–Afghan border must be completed as early as possible so that TTP militants could not sneak into Pakistan to spread terrorism. This fence will also save Pakistan from the spillover of violence and instability in Afghanistan, which might continue for decades.